Nicolas Larralde

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With years of experience in quality assurance within Agile environments, I bring to the table a strong foundation and a detail-oriented approach to software testing. I excel in troubleshooting complex issues, developing necessary subject matter expertise, and adapting seamlessly to both independent and collaborative work settings. I distinguish clearly between quality assurance, a proactive, process-oriented discipline focused on preventing defects through well-defined standards and continuous improvement, and software testing, a product-focused activity aimed at detecting defects through execution and evaluation of live software. Beyond technical expertise, I take pride in fostering a collaborative QA culture, mentoring as well as learning from colleagues, sharing best practices, and sharpening the skills of the QA organization as a whole.

My approach to quality assurance is rooted in building quality into the product from the earliest stages of development, rather than treating testing as a final checkpoint.This is achieved by aligning testing activities with business goals via close collaboration with stakeholders, and active QA participation in design and implementation discussions. The objective is to advocate for code testability and efficient test coverage in order to facilitate fast feedback loops, and foster a shared responsibility for quality across the team.

Feedback early in the SDLC helps teams identify issues sooner, reduce rework and human error, and prevent defects before they reach later stages. I strongly advocate for shift-left testing and continuous testing as key drivers of quality by means of fast feedback loops for developers. This along with accurate requirements traceability helps ensure alignment between requirements, code, and tests at all points in the development process.

At the foundation of my approach is disciplined test management. I understand the importance of aligning project-level test planning with organizational test policies and strategies to ensure testing efforts directly support business objectives. Structured test plans that clearly define test types, levels, techniques, coverage, entry and exit criteria, and estimations allow testing to be predictable, measurable, and well-integrated into the overall delivery process. To guide test coverage and efficiency I rely on the test pyramid model, prioritizing fast, reliable, and cost-effective unit-level tests, while adding higher-level integration and UI tests, as well as costly exploratory testing where it provides the most value.

The expertise of the QA is in validating the technical implementation of the business requirements produced by developers. The technical implementation is the software development team's best-effort interpretation of the business requirements, and as such inevitably introduces errant functionality (bugs) and functionality that conflicts with the broader software project (regressions). The QA is responsible for understanding the intended operation of the technical implementation (happy path) as well as enough of the unintended operation (non-happy-paths) in order to uphold the quality standards of the organization. The primary deliverable of the QA is assurance that the technical implementation delivered by the software teams meets predetermined levels of quality.

I am excited about the opportunity to bring my expertise, energy, and dedication to your organization and contribute to assuring the delivery of quality software products. Thank you for considering my application.

Warmest Regards,

Nicolas Larralde